be shaken from the belief that there was little chance of any real fighting with the Chinese. How could all the warning signs have been ignored?

However, despite the sluggish approach of Army HQ, some steps were taken. Orders had been passed for the setting up of the 3 Himalayan (later Mountain) Division that was to be commanded by Major General Budh Singh, MC. Till the end of September, 114 Brigade was responsible for the whole of Ladakh, but with the setting up of a Division HQ, the brigade's area of responsibility was to be Chushul and the Northern Sector only.

Despite the developing threat, even the induction of additional troops into Ladakh remained haphazard. On 23 September 1962, 13 Kumaon, commanded by Lieutenant Colonel H. S. Dhingra, was engaged in a brigade tactical exercise in Baramulla. On its way back in the afternoon, the battalion was told to move one company immediately to Ladakh. Accordingly, Major G. N. Singh moved to Leh poste-haste, arriving there on 25 September. Just then news came in that the Chinese were getting even more aggressive in their stance, so two days later the rest of the Kumaonis were ordered to move to Leh. Accordingly, the battalion marched to Srinagar (fifty-four kilometres away) from where it was transported to Sonamarg. By 3 October it had reached the outskirts of Leh, having made the exhausting road journey over Zojila and Kargil. Finally, on 12 October its Delta Company was flown into Chushul while Bravo Company followed the next day by road via the Kiari-Dungti road axis. On 24 October, Charlie Company and Battalion HQ also reached Chushul by road.

Similarly, 1 Jat, commanded by Lieutenant Colonel M. S. Jaspal, was deployed in the Uri Sector at Chhota Kazinag, situated at an altitude of 10,500 feet. As these troops were acclimatized, the battalion was ordered to move to Ladakh on 18 October 1962. However, owing to early snowfall, Zojila was closed till 3 November. By then the first phase of fighting in Ladakh was over. The battalion moved to Srinagar on 6 November from where it was airlifted directly to Chushul.

CHINI AYA

In the DBO Sector, the Chinese had occupied the dominating heights that they considered to be the last ridge on the Chinese side. However, once they got there, they realized they had to advance further into Indian territory to dominate the Indo-Sinkiang trade route. This created a problem because the